



Africa **20** **Future** **26** **Leaders**

**Your Journey From Recognition
to Impact Starts Here.**

**The Official Participant Onboarding &
Programme Handbook**



Message From the Founder

Dear Top 100 Africa Future Leaders,

It is with great pride and excitement that I welcome you to the Top 100 Africa Future Leaders. When I first envisioned this program, it was born out of a deep desire to recognize and empower the incredible talent that exists within our continent. Throughout my journey, I have encountered countless brilliant young minds—students who have excelled academically, who have demonstrated leadership in their communities, and who possess the passion and vision to drive change. Yet, I also saw that these remarkable individuals often faced significant barriers—whether it was a lack of recognition, support, or opportunities to fully realize their potential.

The Top 100 Africa Future Leaders Empowerment Summit was created to bridge that gap. My vision for this initiative is to create a platform where Africa's brightest young leaders can be identified, nurtured, and positioned to make a global impact. I believe that each of you has the potential to lead, to innovate, and to inspire others. My hope is that through this program, you will gain not only the skills and knowledge you need but also the confidence and determination to pursue your dreams with unwavering commitment.

Thank you for being part of this vision. I look forward to seeing the incredible things you will accomplish as a Top 100 Africa Future Leader.

With warm regards,



Paul Nwosu Light
Founder, Top 100 Africa Future Leaders

About Top100 Africa Future Leaders

Our Mission

At Top 100 Africa Future Leaders, our mission is to identify, empower, and position Africa's brightest young leaders for global impact. We recognize the immense talent, creativity, and potential that exists within the youth of Africa, and we are committed to providing them with the tools, resources, and support they need to thrive. Our program is designed to uncover the leaders of tomorrow—those who possess the vision, determination, and drive to lead transformative change. By offering mentorship, leadership training, and global exposure, we aim to equip these young leaders with the skills and confidence to make a significant impact, both locally and globally.



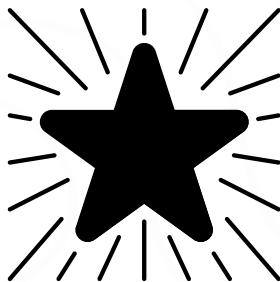
Our Vision

Our long-term vision is to build a powerful network of leaders who will drive change across Africa and the world. We envision a future where Africa's young leaders are not only recognized for their contributions but are also leading the charge in addressing global challenges. By fostering a community of like-minded individuals who are passionate about innovation, social justice, and sustainable development, we aim to create a ripple effect that will inspire and empower future generations. Our ultimate goal is to see Africa's youth at the forefront of global leadership, shaping policies, driving economic growth, and creating a more equitable and prosperous world for all.

Our Values



The Top 100 initiative is guided by a set of core values that reflect our commitment to excellence, innovation, integrity, and community:



Excellence:

We strive for excellence in everything we do. We believe in the pursuit of knowledge, continuous improvement, and the relentless pursuit of high standards. Our inductees are encouraged to push beyond their limits, to strive for greatness, and to never settle for mediocrity.



Integrity

Integrity is at the heart of our initiative. We value honesty, transparency, and ethical leadership. Our leaders are expected to uphold the highest standards of integrity in all their endeavors, and to lead by example in their communities and beyond.



Innovation:

We believe in the power of innovation to solve complex problems and drive progress. We encourage our leaders to think creatively, to challenge the status quo, and to explore new ways of addressing the challenges facing Africa and the world.



Community

We believe in the strength of community and the importance of collaboration. Our program fosters a sense of belonging and mutual support among our inductees. We encourage our leaders to work together, to support one another, and to contribute to the well-being of their communities and society at large.

Together, these values shape the foundation of the Top 100 Africa Future Leaders initiative, guiding our efforts to empower the next generation of African leaders and position them for lasting success.

Meet the 2026 cohort

Across Africa and beyond, thousands of ambitious young people are pursuing a similar vision: to build meaningful careers, create solutions to pressing challenges, lead with purpose, and contribute to a better future for their communities.

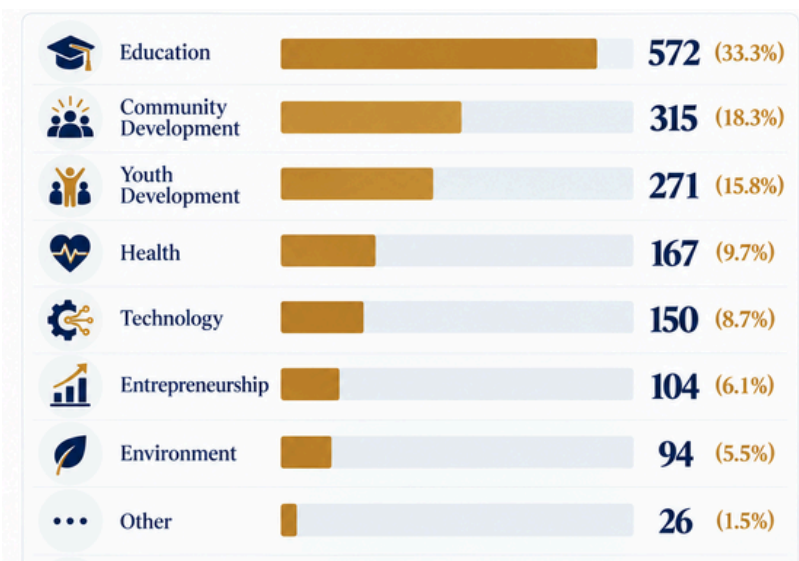
The Africa Future Leaders 2026 programme brings together some of these remarkable individuals, united by academic excellence, leadership potential, and a desire to make a difference.

Our 2026 application cycle recorded 1,717 applications from 61 countries and territories, representing 707 universities and higher education institutions across Africa and internationally.



The 2026 application community represents 707 distinct higher education institutions, Beyond Nigeria, applications came from institutions including Addis Ababa University in Ethiopia, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology in Ghana, Makerere University in Uganda, the University of Bamenda and University of Buea in Cameroon, African Leadership University in Rwanda, and the University of Nairobi in Kenya.

707 Higher Education Institutions Represented



More Than Academic Achievers: Young People Already Making a Difference

What makes the 2026 application community particularly compelling is that many applicants have already begun translating their abilities into tangible contributions.

Across the application pool, young people described initiatives addressing challenges in education, healthcare, technology, community development, youth empowerment, entrepreneurship, environmental sustainability, and other areas.

Getting Started



Personal Dashboard

Manage your profile and access updates



Programmes & Events

Leadership sessions, workshops and more



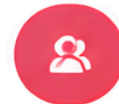
Magazine

Share your story and get featured



Leadership Stories

Learn from other inspiring leaders



Community & Opportunities

Access initiatives, fellowships and more

4.1. Welcome Onboard: Your First Steps

Step 1: Confirm Your Selection - Review your official selection notification and onboarding instructions. Ensure your registered email address is active to receive important updates.

Step 2: Access Your Participant Account - Visit www.top100afl.com and sign in using your registered details or follow the account activation instructions provided.

Step 3: Explore Your Dashboard - Familiarise yourself with your dashboard, where you can manage your profile, view announcements, access programme information, and discover available opportunities.

Step 4: Complete Your Profile - Update your personal and academic information, upload a professional photograph, and highlight your achievements and leadership experience.

Step 5: Stay Connected - Check your dashboard regularly, follow official communication channels, and stay informed about workshops, events, and programme activities.



Personal information
(name, country, contact details)



Academic background
(university, course, graduation year)



Professional photograph
(clear and high-quality)



Your bio and leadership story
(what you do, what you care about)



Achievements and impact
(highlight key projects and results)

ADD THE TOP100 APP TO YOUR PHONE



How to install:

- 1 Open www.top100afl.com on your phone.
- 2 Tap "Add to Home Screen" (in Chrome or Safari).
- 3 Look for the Top100 icon on your home screen.



FEATURE IN 2026 MAGAZINE

- ✓ Update your profile.
- ✓ Prepare your story.
- ✓ Submit your application when announced.

Your selection is an important milestone, but what comes next is equally valuable. Over the coming weeks, you will have opportunities to learn, build new relationships, share your achievements, strengthen your professional profile, and prepare for the Africa Future Leaders Festival in November 2026.

Your Onboarding & Programme Roadmap

AFRICA FUTURE LEADERS 2026

PEOPLE • IDEAS • OPPORTUNITIES • A BRIGHTER AFRICA



October 2026

- Onboarding section
- Virtual empowerment sections and workshops
- Participate in orientation and scheduled leadership sessions.
- When magazine applications opens
- Africa Future leaders platform onboarding
- Prepare your story and submit your editorial feature application if interested.
- Africa Future leaders Award and Certificate Begins

November 2026

- 2026 Africa Future Leaders Award happening live in Lagos Nigeria, Selected awardees would be invited to attend [invitations are strict], Confirm attendance when registration opens and prepare for networking, learning, and recognition.

December 2026

- Project100 scholarship begins
- Maintain meaningful connections and apply what you have learned.
- Dates, activities, and arrangements remain subject to official programme updates.

Your Award & Certificate

Celebrate Your Excellence. Share Your Achievement. Your Africa Future Leaders 2026 award and certificate recognise your academic excellence, leadership potential, and commitment to impact.

How to Access Yours:

1. Sign in at www.top100afl.com.
2. Visit Awards on your dashboard.
3. Make the payment and schedule dispatch

Important: Awards will be officially authorised and presented during the Africa Future Leaders Festival in November 2026 or dispatched immediately after the event to eligible recipients.





You Belong Here, Make it count

Every participant arrives with a different story. Some have overcome significant personal and financial challenges to achieve academic distinction. Some have worked tirelessly to create opportunities for others. Some are still discovering where their talents, interests, and ambitions may lead them.

Throughout this programme, we encourage you to learn intentionally, participate actively, connect meaningfully, and remain open to new possibilities.

Be proud of what you have achieved, but remain curious about what you can still become. Celebrate your recognition, but challenge yourself to create impact beyond it.

Above all, remember that the future of Africa will be shaped not simply by the number of exceptional graduates it produces, but by what those graduates choose to do with their knowledge, influence, and opportunities.

One of the most valuable things you can take away from Africa Future Leaders may not be a workshop, session, certificate, or award. It may be the people you meet.

Imagine connecting with someone whose research complements your own, meeting a future co-founder, discovering a collaborator for a community initiative, or developing a friendship that continues long after the programme.

These possibilities are why we encourage every participant to approach the experience with curiosity, openness, and a willingness to contribute.

Do not limit your interactions to people from your university, country, or professional field. Reach across disciplines and borders.

Learn about the challenges other young leaders are addressing. Share your experiences, celebrate the achievements of others, and look for opportunities to work together.

The relationships you develop here can become a foundation for years of personal growth, professional advancement, collaboration, and shared impact.

Welcome Top100

